Reading and writing an email

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Recognise the parts of an email (partes de un correo)
- Read an email and find key information
- Write an informal email to a friend with greetings, paragraphs and closings
- Use connectors and check your writing

Para pensar

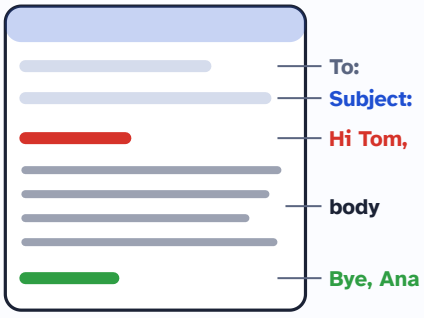
Si escribes a un amigo de Inglaterra, ¿empezarías con «Dear Sir» o con «Hi Tom»? ¿Y cómo te despedirías?

Explicación

The parts of an email

An email has several parts: the address (**To:**), the subject (asunto: what it is about), the greeting (saludo), the **body** (the message, in paragraphs), the closing (despedida) and your **name**.

En castellano: el asunto debe ser corto y claro, por ejemplo «Party on Saturday!» o «Photos from the trip». Así la otra persona sabe de qué trata antes de abrirlo. Después del saludo ponemos una **coma** y empezamos el texto en la línea de abajo.



Greetings and closings

In an **informal** email (to friends and family) we start with Hi..., Hello..., or Dear..., and we finish with **Love,** (family and close friends), **See you soon, Bye for now, Take care,** or **Best wishes,**.

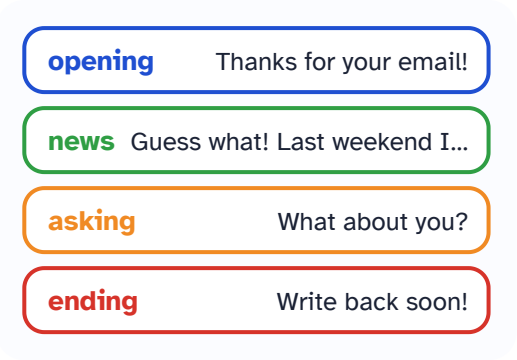
In a **formal** email we start with **Dear Mr Smith,** / **Dear Ms Jones,** / **Dear Sir or Madam,** and finish with **Kind regards,** or **Yours sincerely,**. **En castellano:** es como la diferencia entre «¡Hola, Pablo!» y «Estimado señor:».

	Informal	Formal
Start	Hi Tom,	Dear Mr Smith,
End	Love, / Bye!	Kind regards,

Useful phrases

Opening: «How are you?», «Thanks for your email», «It was great to hear from you», «Sorry I didn't write sooner». **Giving news:** «Guess what!», «I've got some exciting news», «Last weekend I…».

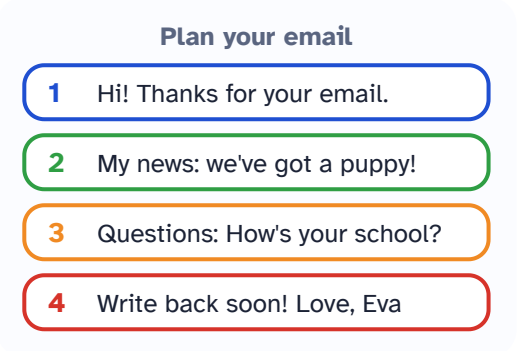
Asking: «What about you?», «Can you come?», «Write back soon!». **Ending:** «I hope to see you soon», «Say hello to your family», «That's all for now». **Consejo:** estas frases hechas son como piezas de Lego: con ellas tu correo sonará natural.



Paragraphs

Organise the body in paragraphs (párrafos), one idea in each. A good plan for a short email: **1)** greeting and why you are writing; **2)** your news or the main information; **3)** questions for your friend; **4)** closing.

Leave a **blank line** between paragraphs. Keep sentences short and clear. **En castellano:** un correo de una sola parrafada es difícil de leer; separar las ideas ayuda a quien lo recibe.



Connectors

Connectors join ideas: **and** (y) adds information, **but** (pero) shows a contrast, **because** (porque) gives a reason, **so** (así que) gives a result, and **also** (también) adds an idea.

«I love my new school **because** the teachers are very nice». «It was raining, **so** we stayed at home». «The film was long **but** exciting». Order words: **first, then, after that, finally**. **Consejo:** usa al menos tres conectores distintos en cada email.

Connector	Spanish
and	y
but	pero
because	porque
so	así que

Reading: an email from a friend

Read the email. **Subject: My birthday party!** «Hi Lucas, How are you? Thanks for the photos of your holiday. They're fantastic! Guess what! It's my birthday next Saturday **and** I'm having a party at the climbing centre. It starts at five o'clock **and** finishes at eight. My mum is going to make a big chocolate cake. Can you come? Please tell me **because** I need to book the places. Write back soon! Love, Mia»

Answer: Where is the party? What time does it start? Why does Mia need an answer?

What?	birthday party
Where?	at the climbing centre
When?	Saturday, 5 to 8 o'clock
Why reply?	to book the places

Writing a reply

A **reply** (respuesta) answers all the questions. Lucas writes: «Hi Mia, Thanks for the invitation! I'd love to come to your party. Climbing is my favourite sport. My dad can take me, **so** I'll be there at five. Do I need special shoes? See you on Saturday! Lucas».

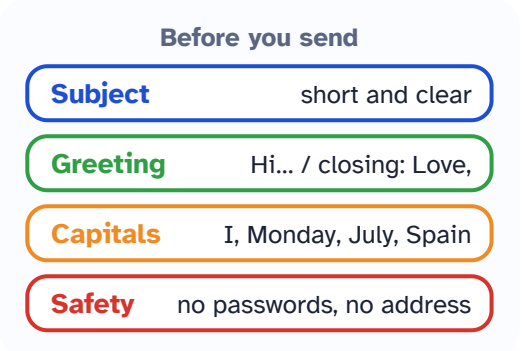
If you can't go, say sorry and give a reason: «I'm really sorry, **but** I can't come **because** I'm visiting my grandparents». **En castellano:** responde siempre a la pregunta principal al principio, y luego añade detalles.



Check before you send

Before clicking **Send**, use this checklist: Is the **subject** clear? Did I use a **greeting** and a **closing**? Are there **paragraphs**? Did I answer **all the questions**? Did I use **capital letters** for names, days and months (Monday, July) and for **I**? Are the verbs in the right tense?

Safety online: only write to people you know, never share passwords or your address with strangers, and ask an adult if a message seems strange. **En castellano:** en internet, la prudencia es lo primero.



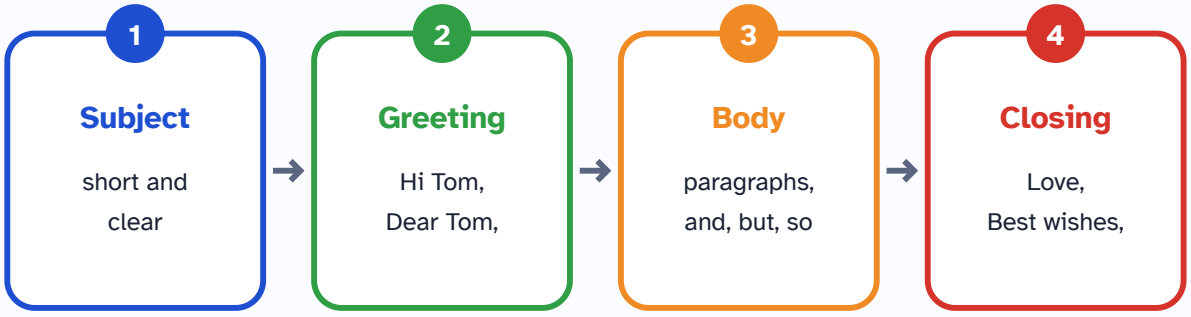
Let's practise: email exchange

Write an email to a pen friend (amigo por correspondencia) from another country. Tell them about you, your family, your school and your town. Ask three questions. Swap emails with a partner and write a reply.

Use this model: «Hi Sam, My name is Pablo and I'm eleven. I live in Teruel, a small city in Spain. I've got one sister. I love football **and** drawing, **but** I don't like Maths very much! What about you? What sports do you play? Write back soon! Best wishes, Pablo».

Hi Sam,	greeting
My name is...	about me
What about you?	questions
Best wishes,	closing + name

Writing an email



Ejercicios

1. **Name four parts of an email.**

2. **Write two informal closings.**

3. **Is «Kind regards» formal or informal?**

4. **Complete: «I'm happy ___ it's Friday!»**

5. **Complete: «I like pizza, ___ I don't like olives.»**

6. **Correct the capitals: «on monday i'm going to london.»**

7. **Write an opening sentence to thank a friend for their email.**

8. **Write a sentence to say no to an invitation politely.**

9. **What should you never share in an email to a stranger?**

10. **Write a short email (40 words) to invite a friend to the cinema.**

Practica

1. **The «subject» of an email is...**
   - **A)** the greeting
   - **B)** what it is about
   - **C)** your name
2. **An informal greeting:**
   - **A)** Dear Sir,
   - **B)** Yours sincerely,
   - **C)** Hi Tom,
3. **An informal closing:**
   - **A)** Love,
   - **B)** Dear,
   - **C)** To:
4. **A formal closing:**
   - **A)** Bye for now,
   - **B)** See ya!
   - **C)** Kind regards,
5. **«because» means...**
   - **A)** pero
   - **B)** porque
   - **C)** así que
6. **«It was late, ___ we went home.»**
   - **A)** so
   - **B)** but
   - **C)** because
7. **Which needs a capital letter?**
   - **A)** school
   - **B)** Tuesday
   - **C)** dog
8. **«Write back soon!» means...**
   - **A)** ¡Escribe más largo!

B) ¡Vuelve pronto!

C) ¡Contesta pronto!

9. **One idea per...**

A) paragraph

B) subject

C) closing

10. **What should you NOT send to a stranger?**

A) a greeting

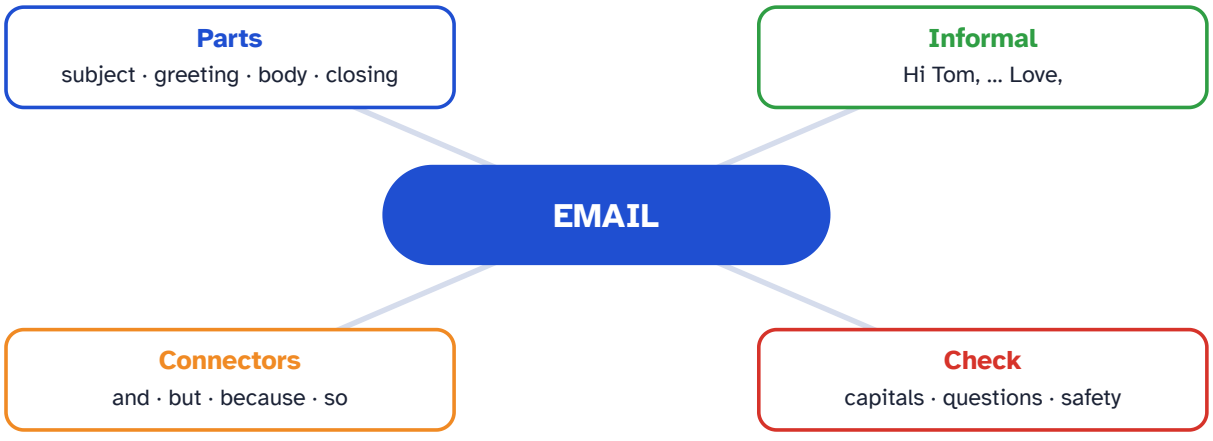
B) your password

C) a question

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Cuáles son las partes de un email; Diferencia entre email formal e informal; Para qué sirven los conectores and, but, because y so; Qué hay que revisar antes de enviar.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

Subject

Asunto: de qué trata el email.

Hi… / Dear…

Saludos de un email informal.

Love, / Best wishes,

Despedidas informales.

Kind regards,

Despedida formal.

because

Porque: da una razón.

so

Así que: da un resultado.

Write back soon!

¡Contesta pronto!

Paragraph

Párrafo: una idea en cada uno.

Soluciones

1. **B)** Asunto.
2. **C)** Para amigos.
3. **A)** Despedida familiar.
4. **C)** Formal.
5. **B)** Da una razón.
6. **A)** Resultado.
7. **B)** Días de la semana.
8. **C)** Pide respuesta.
9. **A)** Párrafo.
10. **B)** Seguridad.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. Subject, greeting, body, closing (y To / name).
2. Love, / Best wishes, / See you soon, / Bye for now,
3. Formal.
4. because.
5. but.
6. On Monday I'm going to London.
7. Thanks for your email! / It was great to hear from you.
8. I'm really sorry, but I can't come because I've got a match.
9. Passwords, your address, phone number or photos.
10. Model answer: Hi Leo, Do you want to come to the cinema on Saturday? There's a new animated film. It starts at six. My mum can pick you up. Write back soon! Bye, Nora